

Cycling

Cycling is a global sport, enjoyed by people of all ages. Most ride for fun, but many compete in disciplines such as track or road racing, or in BMX or mountain bike events.



Lightweight helmet

Breathable clothing

MOUNTAIN BIKING

Mountain biking (MTB) is one of the newest cycling sports, started by cyclists riding off-road trails in California, USA, in the late 1970s. Cross-country mountain biking became an Olympic event in 1996.

Gloves cushion the hands

RIDER PROFILE

As well as stamina and strong pedalling power, mountain bikers need balance and excellent technical skills to negotiate difficult off-road terrain.

ROUGH TERRAIN

Lifting the bike's wheels to get over an obstruction on the trail is known as bunny-hopping. The rider approaches the obstacle quickly, then lifts the handlebar and tucks his feet up under his body at the same time.



EVENTS

MTB is still quite a new sport and different types of competitions have been developed in recent years.

CROSS-COUNTRY

Riders race each other for a fixed number of laps of a circuit. The first to cross the finish line is the winner.

DOWNHILL

Competitors ride individually against the clock, down a hillside course. The fastest time wins.

TRIALS

Riders compete in various tests of poise, nerve, and artistry on their bikes, and are awarded points by judges.

ENDURO

Originating in France, a long-distance race in which only the downhill sections are timed and count towards the rider's finishing time.

MOUNTAIN BIKE

A mountain bike must be sturdy, to cope with bumpy trails, but still light enough to be manoeuvrable.



Low frame height makes it easier to climb at low speed

Up to 30 gears

Fat, knobby tyres for good grip over rough ground

RIDER PROFILE

BMX riders need to be flexible and fit. Freestylers have style and creative flair.

Gloves stop hands from slipping

Full-length trousers with padded knees



Helmet with mouth guard

BMX

BMX (bicycle motocross) began as an offshoot of motocross (off-road motorcycle racing). Riders use specially designed bikes to perform freestyle tricks and stunts, or to race over a dirt track or obstacle course.

FLATLAND RIDING

A form of freestyle, flatland involves riders performing on flat surfaces with no ramps, jumps, or grindrails. It is probably the most technically demanding BMX discipline.

EVENTS

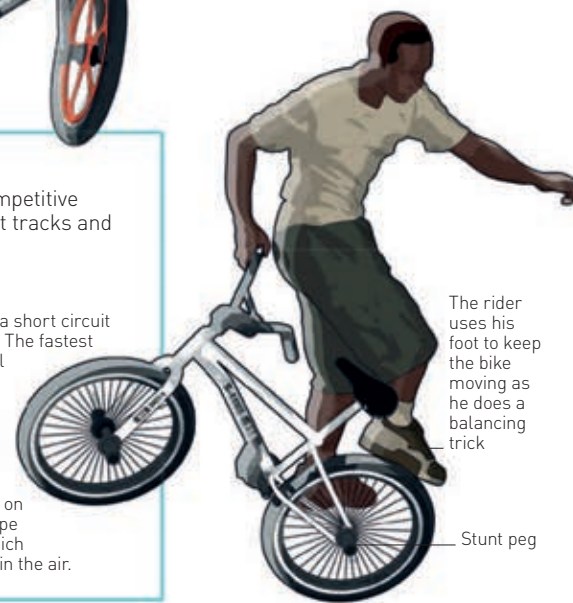
There are two types of competitive BMX riding – racing on dirt tracks and freestyle tricks.

RACING

Eight riders race in heats over a short circuit with different turns and jumps. The fastest riders then compete in the final race. BMX racing became an Olympic sport in 2008.

FREESTYLE

Divided into four main styles: base tricks (the basic moves); grind and lip tricks, performed on railings or the edge of a half-pipe structure; and aerial tricks, which are acrobatic turns and jumps in the air.



The rider uses his foot to keep the bike moving as he does a balancing trick

Stunt peg

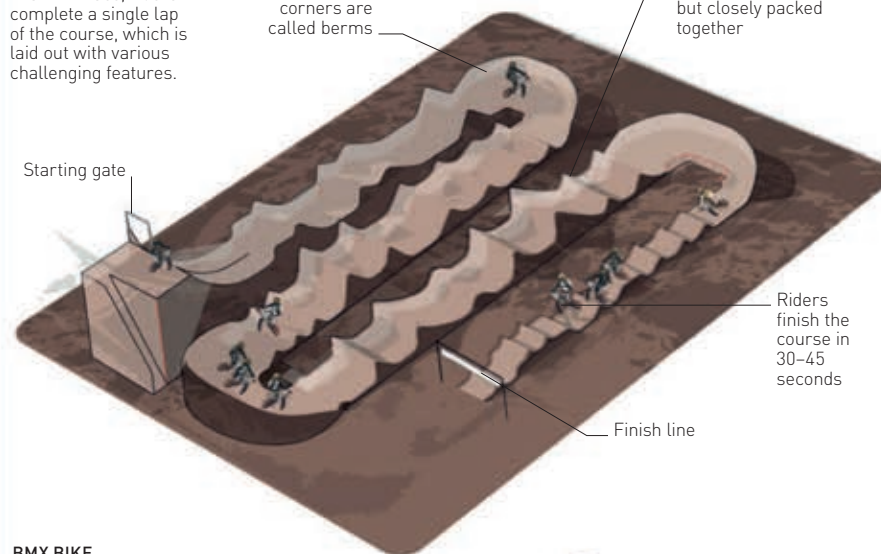
DIRT TRACK

In a BMX race, riders complete a single lap of the course, which is laid out with various challenging features.

Banked turns or corners are called berms

Jumps are small, but closely packed together

Starting gate



Riders finish the course in 30–45 seconds

Finish line

BMX BIKE

Racing bikes are single-speed and designed for quick acceleration. Freestyle bikes are similar but often have stunt pegs attached, for riders to stand on when performing tricks.

Single gear

Sturdy frame

Solid handlebar grips

Small wheels allow fast acceleration

